

Live streaming games have been one of the hottest topics on many platforms for the last few years. Watching game plays with commentary and description by popular video game players has always made them a part of the trending videos whenever posted online. Along with attracting large crowds of gamers, it also brings large profits to streamers through ad revenues and provides free promotions to game developers.

The global lockdown in 2020 due to COVID 19 resulted in the cancellation of concerts, music festivals, and other such events, compelling every artist to shift online. The music industry was gravely affected and lost a major chunk of its revenue.

Live streaming videos are known to have background music added by the content creators or are already a part of the product being used, such as video games. This has piqued the interest of the music industry recently. And with the rising popularity of live streaming games, it brought an increase in the number of copyright issues and claims made by music labels and game developers.

Top live streaming platforms had to bring in laws to protect both the content creators and game developers. It is important for any individual new to this field to understand how various platforms deal with such cases before creating their own live streaming game content.

Twitch

The top live streaming platform, Twitch, has one of the highest daily numbers of users. This live streaming network promotes creating communities with similar interests. It is free to use with the premium version where ads can be removed. There are broadcasts available in sports, music, travel, talk shows, video games, etc.

But, there has been an ongoing battle between Twitch and the music industry for some time, and this has included video game live streamers and similar content creators in it. A blog post titled “Music-Related Copyright Claims and Twitch” was released in November 2020, providing detailed information regarding the issue. Complying with the DMCA (Digital Millennium Copyright Act) rules, Copyright Law in the US, and various other global laws, Twitch asked its content creators to stop using copyrighted music in their videos.

Livestream game content creators do not fall under the copyright issues related to the video games, because they fall under the purview of fair use,